infantry battalion with a squadron of armour from Bezawada in the east; four infantry battalions were to protect Indian lines of communication, while two Hawker Tempest fighter squadrons of the Royal Indian Air Force (RIAF) provided air support from Poona.





This 1929-dated .303 SMLE Mk III bolt-action rifle was manufactured at Ishapore Arsenal, India. (Highwood Classic Arms)

In June 1948, Operation *Kabaddi* saw small bodies of Indian Army infantry being deployed along the 644km-long border. Commencing Operation *Polo* at 2000hrs on 12 September, 1 Armoured Division's infantry soon captured the initial objectives, allowing 1 Armoured Brigade to advance largely unopposed. Moving cautiously to avoid civilian